

WORKED KEY

Full Name: _____

Period: _____

This practice is built exactly like the real test — same questions, same order, different numbers. Work every problem, then check the worked key. Anything you miss is exactly what to study.

1. Simplify: $\sqrt{80}$

Answer: $\sqrt{(16 \cdot 5)} = 4\sqrt{5}$

2. Simplify: $\sqrt{108}$

Answer: $\sqrt{(36 \cdot 3)} = 6\sqrt{3}$

3. Simplify: $\sqrt{(64k^2)}$

Answer: $8k$

4. Simplify: $\sqrt{6} \cdot \sqrt{3}$

Answer: $\sqrt{18} = 3\sqrt{2}$

5. Simplify: $5\sqrt{7} + 2\sqrt{7} - 3\sqrt{7}$

Answer: $4\sqrt{7}$

6. Simplify: $\sqrt{50} + 4\sqrt{2}$

Answer: $5\sqrt{2} + 4\sqrt{2} = 9\sqrt{2}$

7. Rationalize the denominator: $12/\sqrt{6}$

Answer: multiply by $\sqrt{6}/\sqrt{6}$: $12\sqrt{6}/6 = 2\sqrt{6}$

8. Rationalize the denominator: $4/\sqrt{20}$

Answer: $4/(2\sqrt{5}) = 2/\sqrt{5} \rightarrow$ multiply by $\sqrt{5}/\sqrt{5}$: $2\sqrt{5}/5$

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9. Simplify: $(5n^3)^3$

Answer: $5^3 \cdot n^9 = 125n^9$

10. Simplify. Write your answer with a positive exponent: n^2 / n^8

Answer: $n^{-6} = 1/n^6$

11. Error Analysis — Rex evaluated $\sqrt{(64 + 225)}$ as $8 + 15 = 23$. Identify his mistake, then evaluate correctly.

Answer: the root of a SUM is not the sum of the roots — add first: $\sqrt{289} = 17$

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12. Evaluate each expression.

a. $81^{(1/2)}$

Answer: $\sqrt{81} = 9$

b. $216^{(1/3)}$

Answer: $\sqrt[3]{216} = 6$

13. Solve: $\sqrt{x - 7} = 8$

Answer: square both sides: $x - 7 = 64 \rightarrow x = 71$

Cumulative Review — ACT Style. Circle the best answer.

14. Which ordered pair solves the system $x + y = 10$ and $x - y = 4$?

(A) (6, 4)

(B) **(7, 3)**

(C) (3, 7)

(D) (8, 2)

Answer: $7 + 3 = 10$ ✓ and $7 - 3 = 4$ ✓

15. Solve the compound inequality: $3 < x + 4 \leq 9$

(E) $7 < x \leq 13$

(F) $-1 \leq x < 5$

(G) **$-1 < x \leq 5$**

(H) $3 < x \leq 9$

Answer: subtract 4 from all parts

16. Which line is parallel to $y = -2x + 5$ through (0, -4)?

(A) $y = 2x - 4$

(B) $y = -(1/2)x - 4$

(C) **$y = -2x - 4$**

(D) $y = -2x + 4$

Answer: parallel keeps slope -2; $b = -4$